

Areena Arora

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EXPERIENCE

Editorial Coder | May 2025 -
The Hindu, Chennai

- Responsible for turning data stories into interactive experiences for a digital audience.
- Building and maintaining datasets to be used for reporting projects. Worked on SIR, election and budget data extensively.

Data and Investigative Reporter | Sept 2022 - Feb 2025
Knox News, Knoxville (local daily newspaper)

- Watchdog public education-beat reporter. Generated an average of 100,000+ monthly page views.
- Created and managed databases on property sales, crime and government budgets. Conducted newsroom data trainings.

Senior Sub-Editor | Dec 2019 - July 2021
InMobi Glance, Bengaluru

- Co-led a team of six editors curating news feed for millions of users in India, Singapore, and U.S.
- Wrote and edited breaking news, worked closely with designers to optimize content for 100 million+ users.

News Publishing Specialist | July 2018 - Dec 2019
Reuters, Bengaluru

- Redesigned bond market and forex market newsletters to make them clearer. Also streamlined workflow for newsletter creation. Trained in company news reporting.

Reporter | June 2017 - April 2018
Idaho Press, Nampa (local daily newspaper)

EDUCATION

Columbia University, Graduate School of Journalism
M.S. Data Journalism, August 2022

- Honours in Media Ethics

Ohio Wesleyan University
B.A. Journalism and Economics, May 2017

LANGUAGES

Fluent in Hindi and Punjabi

Beginner level in Odia

SELECT PROJECTS

- Chennai heat index: [Interactive project](#) on how heat and humidity affect people differently.
- Responsible for scraping, analyzing and reporting from SIR data involving crores of voter records.
- Investigated [the effect of private fundraising on public schools](#) using nonprofit data.

TALK

[Workshop on designing interactive stories for mobile screens - Upcoming](#)
[Lightning talk at NICAR 2022 in Atlanta](#)

SKILLS

- **Reporting and editing**
- **Data analysis:** Python (Pandas, BeautifulSoup, Selenium), SQL and R
- **Data visualization and mapping:** Adobe Illustrator, QGIS, Mapbox, D3.js and Python libraries
- **Web development:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript

AWARDS

Best AI-driven News Product
World Association of News Publishers
April 2026

First place for use of AI to assist with large-scale computing for SIR data-related reporting

Golden Press Card, East Tennessee Society of Professional Journalists
May 2025

First place in general reporting, two second place awards in government/politics reporting and series writing
2024: First place for covering special ed
2025: Two first and one second place

Tennessee Press Association
July 2024

Three first place awards: Best Education reporting in the state, single feature and digital presentation

OpenNews Scholarship+, 2022